

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in employment law, case file management, tribunal support and client communication. Currently advising clients on employment, housing, benefits and debt matters at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, managing matters from instruction through to submission. Previous experience at BCLP supporting hearing preparation, preparing electronic bundles, maintaining matter records and tracking procedural deadlines across multiple concurrent files. Strong organisational and written communication skills, with a clear and client-focused approach to explaining procedural requirements.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients on employment, welfare benefits, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets procedural deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Translates procedural requirements and legal obligations into clear, practical guidance for clients, including those with limited prior experience of legal proceedings

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Handled court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Maintained matter records using iManage; prepared client notes and assisted with correspondence

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of formal submissions
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions under time pressure shortly before a significant filing deadline, helping to ensure on-time submission
- Liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems; document review

Case and evidence management: Case file management, evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, deadline tracking, confidential document handling